The Burning of Zozobra

Presented by the Kiwanis Club of Santa Fe

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Tuesday, October 13, 2026

The Taos News

Dear Friends at The Taos News,

You know the moment. Fort Marcy Park goes dark, fifty thousand of your neighbors go quiet, and then the whole field finds its voice: “Burn him! Burn him!” The Fire Spirit dances out of the shadows, Old Man Gloom groans, and a year of Santa Fe’s sorrow goes up in flames. For 102 years that moment has belonged to everyone. I’m writing to ask your business to help keep it that way.

Here is what most people never see. Children 10 and under get in free. General Admission stays at $30, with no fees. Five thousand tickets, worth $150,000, go to New Mexico families who could not otherwise be there. We pay for police and professional security, free shuttles and a free ADA shuttle, and four free days of ZozoFest. Those are promises, and we intend to keep every one of them. I want to be upfront with you: they cost more every year, and in 2026 many of the small businesses that used to send us a thousand or two simply couldn’t. Sponsorships are how we hold the line without charging kids or raising the ticket price.

October is when businesses set next year’s budgets, so I’m asking now. Please put us in your 2027 budget with a Zozobra the Balloon RC Balloon sponsorship at $5,000. Zozobra the Balloon is our 135-foot hot air balloon in Old Man Gloom’s image, and he flew five times at the 2026 Albuquerque International Balloon Fiesta. You are the named sponsor at the radio-controlled balloon rally of your choice and on burnzozobra.com, and it includes a radio-controlled Zozobra balloon inflation at your company event, a place on the crew at balloon events, a company photo op, your banner at the Burning of Zozobra, and two Premium Viewing seats for the 103rd Burning. The full **Zozobra the Balloon deck** has every level. We would gladly take part or all of it as a media trade.

Your name will be in front of the people who matter most to a Santa Fe business. In 2026, 49,732 people came through the gates, and 39,890 of them live right here in Santa Fe County. Another 1.2 million watched on KOAT-TV and the livestream, our Facebook posts reached 7.1 million people, and burnzozobra.com logged 1.8 million visits.

Every level is in our **2027 sponsorship deck**, from a $500 Flare-Up on the main stage to a $45,000 sponsorship that puts your logo on the light-up wristbands of 45,000 guests. If a different fit makes more sense, we will build a custom package around your business. In-kind support counts just as much as a check: printing, signage, catering and equipment all lower our costs and leave more for kids. And if you want to be with us all year, we can bundle Zozobra with Día de los Muertos on the Plaza, which drew 46,891 people in 2025, and New Year’s Eve on the Plaza.

Your gift works twice. It keeps Zozobra affordable for every family, and once the bills are paid, net proceeds go to the Santa Fe Downtown Kiwanis Foundation for grants to nonprofits serving our children. In 2025 those grants totaled $100,000 for organizations serving more than 24,000 kids.

You can **apply online** in a few minutes and pay by credit card, check or invoice, see every level on our **sponsors page**, or call me directly at 206-719-9652. Sponsors who commit by Friday, January 15, 2027, will be in our full spring campaign when tickets go on sale Tuesday, April 13, 2027.

Thank you for everything you already do for Santa Fe. Let's burn some gloom together.

¡Viva el Viejo!



Raymond G. Sandoval, Esq.
Zozobra Event Chairman